SECOND LIVE-SITE TEST PASS

CivicLens QA retest

Result: 1 original issue fixed, 8 still present, 3 additional findings. The simulator now loads and supports interactive scenarios. The most important remaining risks are unreliable free-text assistance and misleading or inconsistent analysis.

18 October 2026 | Desktop Chrome | 1363 x 936 viewport
Site: https://civiclens-sotonship2026.onrender.com/

Regression results against the first report

ID	Retest	Current evidence
F01	FIXED	Simulator works from the navigation, landing-page Test a site, and a direct reload.
F02	STILL FAILS	The same typed planning question now returns Groq API error 403: error code: 1010, replacing the previous missing-index error.
F03	STILL FAILS	Infinity x comparisons remain in Portswood and Bargate.
F04	STILL FAILS	Portswood still shows Food and drink - 0, despite its tooltip showing 90. Retail likewise shows 0 versus 71.
F05	STILL FAILS	Evidence connected and Evidence service online remain visible after the provider error.
F06	STILL FAILS	SO14 2BY returns 14 places; SO142BY and a double internal space return 0.
F07	STILL FAILS	A failed name search still produces No type matches "".
F08	STILL FAILS	Comparison uses 2023 vacancy values without a year; cited PDF still contains 2024 values.
F09	STILL FAILS	"Leading sector" still changes meaning with map mode, without naming the metric.

Fix next: restore the assistant provider connection; prevent unknown business descriptions receiving strong opportunity scores; repair area aggregation; resolve validation warnings and population totals. Then address data-period wording and search polish.

New findings are F10-F12 below. This report records observed behavior; code-level causes have not been verified. The first report remains a historical baseline.

01 / NEW SIMULATOR FINDING

Unknown input gets a top score

F10 | High | Unrecognised text becomes a 100/100 opportunity

Reproduce: Open Simulator. Select Day nursery, then replace What do you want to open? with zzzz_QA_unknown_business_123 and press Enter. Keep Whole Southampton and the default 800 m distance.

Actual: The app treats the text as a business type, ranks Bevois first, and displays 100/100 - Strong opportunity. The Stands out bar is 100, with 0 similar businesses within 800 m. The explanation says nothing like this business is in the data and describes it as a possible market gap.

Existing safeguard: A warning does say demand is unproven, and the left-side note asks for an on-the-ground check. These warnings are useful, but they do not prevent the prominent strong-opportunity score for an uninterpretable input.

Expected: Distinguish an unknown or invalid description from a recognized business with genuinely low competition. Missing evidence should not automatically improve the score.

Fix direction: Require a recognized category, a sufficiently supported interpretation, or explicit user confirmation of the interpretation. For unsupported types, show Insufficient evidence and withhold a commercial score. Do not let zero database matches imply proven market opportunity.

Acceptance checks: The exact nonsense string cannot receive a strong commercial recommendation. Test a recognized category, a genuine novel category, a misspelling, and unsupported text. Show the interpreted business category and any fallback visibly.

What the simulator now does successfully

Action	Observed outcome
Open from both entry points	Loads successfully, including after direct refresh.
Select Cafe, Day nursery or Pharmacy	Recalculates sites, scores and customer groups.
Choose Portswood	Returns three pharmacy site candidates for the sampled scenario.
Change distance to 400 m / 1,200 m	Updates labels to about 5 / 15 minutes and recalculates results.
Next site / Show that site	Moves between candidates and opens the suggested relocation.
Try to deselect all customer ages	Keeps one group selected; an empty selection is prevented.
Flood overlay control	Can be checked and the Flood zone 3 legend appears. Geometry accuracy was not verified.

Reconcile totals and validation

F11 | Medium | Target customers can exceed all residents

Reproduce: Select Pharmacy > Choose an area > Portswood. Set walking distance to 400 m with the slider Home key, and inspect the first suggested site with all customer age groups selected.

Actual: Who benefits displays 5,151 residents in total, but 5,165 target customers. The displayed age groups are 195, 387, 1,733, 1,502, 783 and 565; these sum to 5,165. A second example, F10 in Bevois at 800 m, shows 24,187 residents versus 24,195 target customers.

Interpretation: The discrepancies are small and may arise from independently estimated age groups, but that cause was not established. The interface presents them as counts of the same population without explaining the inconsistency.

Fix / acceptance: Reconcile age estimates with the displayed population total before aggregation, or clearly identify that different estimates are being compared. For one consistent population basis, the selected-group count must not exceed the total; all selected ages should reconcile with it.

F12 | Medium | High-confidence brief has an unresolved number-check warning

Reproduce: Refresh Simulator, select Day nursery, keep Whole Southampton and 800 m, then expand Planning brief for the council (numbers checked) for the first Bevois recommendation.

Actual: The brief includes commercial viability 100/100 and Confidence: High. Beneath it, a red badge says "1 numbers not in the data". This reproduced again after a fresh reload. The UI does not identify which number failed.

Expected: A validation failure must affect the presentation of the brief. Explain which value failed and distinguish an unverified draft from a fully verified result.

Fix / acceptance: Resolve the unsupported value or validator false positive; do not assume which it is. Use a status such as Needs review, highlight the failed claim, and avoid an unqualified verified heading or high-confidence message while the check is unresolved.

Additional discrepancy to investigate

The default Freemantle cafe scenario lists competitors at 230 m and 250 m, while its council brief says there is 1 existing cafe within 400 m. The feasibility text mentions 2 nearby cafes; the headline says 9 within 800 m. Different radii can explain the 2-versus-9 difference, but the 1-versus-2 comparison needs reconciliation or an explicit category/geometry distinction. This is an investigation note, not a separately counted confirmed defect.

03 / REMAINING FAILURES

Reproduction and release checks

Assistant and evidence

F02 + F05: Submit "What planning restrictions should I investigate before opening a new cafe in Portswood?" The response is "Groq API error 403: error code: 1010" while the status remains healthy. Diagnose the server-to-provider request and show a user-facing unavailable state. The provider error alone does not establish its precise cause.

F08: Use Compare Shirley and Portswood. It returns 10.94% and 6.45%, with no observation year. The reloaded source PDF at page 6 labels those values 2023 and shows 2024 values of 10.57% and 4.84%. Use the appropriate year explicitly.

F09: Ask that comparison in Most common mode: Portswood Food and drink / Shirley Retail. Repeat in Stands out vs city: Health / Health. Name the statistic as most common or most overrepresented instead of using the same undefined "leading" wording.

Area profiles and search

F03 + F04: Popular > Stands out vs city > click Portswood. Infinity x remains, as do the false zero sector counts. Bargate also shows Infinity x. Current cafe counts are 27 in Portswood and 108 in Bargate; do not reuse the first report's old cafe counts when checking the latest aggregation.

F06 + F07: Clear area and detailed-type filters in Places. Compare SO14 2BY with SO142BY and SO14 2BY. Then search zzzz_QA_no_such_place_123 with Detailed type empty. Normalize postcode spacing and show a no-results message for the actual name/postcode search.

Other checks and limits

Tesco and padded lowercase tesco both return 32 results. Punctuation, harmless markup and 2,048 characters did not crash venue search. The cited PDF still opens at page 6. Preset comparisons still respond after the free-text failure. These are sampled passes, not proof of overall correctness.

Desktop Chrome only. Mobile layouts, other browsers, real walking routes, flood geometry, full accessibility, server-side security and load/concurrency were not verified. The site and its deployment were not modified. New findings are newly observed because the simulator is now reachable; they are not necessarily regressions introduced by this update.

Release gate: an arbitrary planning question succeeds with sources; unsupported business input cannot receive an unjustified score; area statistics and population totals reconcile; every displayed verified brief passes its own checks. Then run mobile and second-browser smoke tests.

Source checked in the live browser: /api/evidence/data/raw/project/southampton_business_opportunity_data.pdf#page=6. Historical baseline: CivicLens QA Report, 18 October 2026, first pass.